# Staff answers and source guide

**Data status**

Illustrative practice data. All figures and report dates are made up. They do not describe real work or real places.

The precise outcome is retained: I can use current data on opportunities, skills demand, pay or growth to draw a cautious conclusion about a career area.

Use the fictional report date of 2 November 2026 to practise provenance checks. Distinguish it from the periods in the column headers. These sources have no real region, organisation or employer. The task does not evidence actual current labour-market conditions.

**Practice source A**

| Sector | Earlier | Later | Change |
|---|---|---|---|
| Health and care | 12 | 18 | 6 more |
| Construction | 20 | 24 | 4 more |
| Retail | 30 | 24 | 6 fewer |
| Education | 18 | 21 | 3 more |

Source A counts advert records in the same fictional collection over 1–28 September and 1–28 October 2026. Both windows last 28 days. The collection is not complete. Counts are not people hired, all jobs or a person's chance of selection.

Model answer: "Source A, fictional report date 2 November 2026, shows construction advert records rose from 20 to 24 between the two 28-day windows. This suggests four more records in this set. It does not prove a lasting trend or guarantee a job. I would next check the tasks and skills in those adverts."

Retail and construction both have 24 in October. Their changes differ: retail fell from 30; construction rose from 20. A latest count and a change answer different questions. Avoid calling either sector best.

Lesson resource · CC BY-NC-SA 4.0: free for classroom use, share and adapt with credit, no resale

# Forecast answers and limits

**Practice source B**

| Sector | Starting posts | Forecast posts | Predicted change |
|---|---|---|---|
| Health and care | 100 | 108 | 8 more |
| Construction | 100 | 104 | 4 more |
| Retail | 100 | 96 | 4 fewer |
| Education | 100 | 102 | 2 more |

Source B, fictional report date 2 November 2026, uses invented October 2026 starting counts and October 2027 predictions for total posts in a different collection. Every sector starts at 100 for teaching simplicity. Posts may be occupied. The table does not count vacancies or jobs to apply for.

The conditional assumption is that the made-up service and spending plans stay the same. A plan change could change the result. The forecast is not an observed future fact.

Model answer: “In source B, the construction forecast is 104 total posts for October 2027, from a made-up baseline of 100. The model suggests four more posts if its plans hold. This is uncertain and does not mean 104 vacancies today. I would ask what evidence and assumptions support the forecast before applying it to a real choice.”

A and B have different units and collections. Do not combine counts, calculate a vacancy rate from them, or use B to prove A. Either source can support the independent task when the learner states its unit and limit. Calculating differences is helpful but not mandatory; accurate direct values also support a conclusion.

Lesson resource · CC BY-NC-SA 4.0: free for classroom use, share and adapt with credit, no resale

# Checks, prompts and misconceptions

### Retrieval

Retail is a sector. Checkout assistant is an occupation. If Week 1 was missed, supply this neutral example without marking prior completion. Invite a question about numbers, tasks or skills.

### After the model

The unit in A is advert records, not people hired. The report date is 2 November; the two counting windows appear in the column headers. Re-model these labels if needed.

### Hinge and parallel hinge

Main hinge: B is correct. Source A counted 24 retail adverts in its October window; it cannot show everyone can get a retail job. Ask for evidence and a limit. If incorrect or unsupported, point to the unit and re-model before independent work.

Parallel hinge: A is correct. Source B suggests 104 construction posts in October 2027 if its plans hold; it does not show 104 jobs available today. Revisit future date and assumption if needed. Record unresolved uncertainty and the chosen support.

### Source/date checks

Ask: What is the source label? Is its report date the same as its data period? What is counted? Is the future number observed or predicted? What does the source leave out? In a real inquiry, check who produced the data, method, coverage, update date and fit to the question. A recent date alone does not establish trustworthiness.

### Misconceptions

“More adverts means I will get a job.” Correct with the limits of advert counts and personal selection. “Forecasts are facts.” Correct with the assumptions and future date. The word “may” alone cannot rescue a claim contradicted by the table.

### Supported and Floor

Keep the separate model, source strips, vocabulary bank and one-row view. Floor key is A, B, A, A, B, A. Accept speaking or pointing with a faithful scribe. Record the learner’s own selections before any explanation that supplies an answer.

Lesson resource · CC BY-NC-SA 4.0: free for classroom use, share and adapt with credit, no resale

# Evidence and feedback guide

### Core evidence

Source J10 calls for LMI analysis with source/date and cautious conclusion. Collect one individual response with accurate data, unit/period, a claim that follows, a relevant limit and one implication for further research. Record missing elements separately. Do not require all four sectors or all types of LMI; the source outcome uses opportunities, skills demand, pay or growth.

Secure practice: “In A, retail goes from 30 to 24 adverts. That is fewer in the later window. It does not show all retail work. I would check the skills asked for.” Source/report date and periods should be present in the record or clearly pointed to. Partial: a correct number without a claim, or a claim with no source/date. Unsupported: “Retail has no jobs” or “I will get a job.”

### Example next steps

“Add the source and report date.” “Name what the 24 counts.” “Change your claim so it only says what the row supports.” Give one precise next step, then retain the learner’s response.

### Access and independence

Normal reading, scribing, calculator or typing access does not by itself reduce independence of thought. Record answer prompts separately. Fade prompts without removing normal access. No cold calling or compulsory public performance.

### Portfolio and marking

Keep the first claim, support, revised claim and next question in the Careers Portfolio/action plan. Offer to the Communication portfolio. VF verbal feedback; WS supported; I independent; NS next step; // self-edit; ? read back; E actual banked evidence; R after Voice, Audience, NS and learner response in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode.

### Fidelity boundary

The scheme outcome and 40-minute sequence are retained. Generic illustrative sets replace named-area/current-data research by owner instruction. Record successful interpretation of the practice sets. Full use of current real-world data would require a separate later application with a checked source; do not claim it here. Week 2 is formative. Week 7 is assessing, with mixed formative/summative source marking retained for Week 6.

Lesson resource · CC BY-NC-SA 4.0: free for classroom use, share and adapt with credit, no resale